

Paper 2

SAQ

Use of language qn:

- Choice of words → meaning + context
 - 'Even' → surprising, unexpected or extreme point of intensity
 - 'Perhaps' → suggesting an alternative to a point to prompt reader to think or do
- pronouns

Rhetorical devices

- Differences (paradox & oxymoron), contrasts, irony (**S**ituation, **E**xpected, **A**ctual)
- Figures of speech → metaphor, simile & analogy (use something to simple to explain something complicated)

Illustrations to support

- Data
- Trends
- Examples
- Observations
- Anecdotes

Punctuation

- Brackets → clarify/qualify point previously made, add information, to express an opinion different from the one presented previously
- Dashes → functions like a colon in denoting elaboration of clarification
- Ellipses → to show that the list of examples given by the author is non-exhaustive
- Inverted commas → author does not mean what they say (sarcasm), word is not used in the conventional sense, words in the inverted commas are the view of others which the author disagrees with (most common)

First paragraph:

Look out for opening statement (first sentence), intentions:

- Pique the interest of reader
- Engage (connect with the readers)
- Hint at the objective of the paragraph/text (through the use of stylistic techniques → refer to rhetorical devices)

First-person → inclusive, assume agreement

Second-person → engaging

Third-person → objective/distancing

Answer technique/format:

Purposes of ____ qn:

1. Purpose
2. Technique
3. Context

How does the author show/illustrate?:

1. What is the illustration?
2. What type of illustration? (refer to 'illustration to support')
3. What is the point it illustrates
4. How does the illustration support the point

Why does the author uses ____? E.g Why do you think the author switches to 'we' in the final paragraph?

- Function + context

'Explain the meaning of...' different from 'Explain why...' qn:

- Explain the meaning of → paraphrase to have the meaning in context
- Explain why → intention + meaning

Paraphrase qn:

- Identify directional words (what ways/explain how/why/etc)
- Find relevant material based on the directional words
- Highlight the material in the insert to avoid lifting
- Organise/structure the material to answer the question
- Used to explain the links between the directional words and the effect/outcome
- MUST USE YOUR OWN WORDS

Use of punctuation:

- The function of the punctuation
- What is common among the list of items
- The author's intention

Use of illustration:

Identify

- The point the author wants to make
- The illustration
- Contextualise your answer by showing the link(s) between the author's point and the illustration

Contrast/Difference:

Identify

- Opposites/differences (usually unclear even when explicit material is given)
- Contrast/difference must be expressed explicitly (made clear)
- Write your answers in contrastive pairs

Irony:

Identify

- Situation presented
- Expected outcome

- Actual outcome
- Identify and explain how the expected and actual are opposites

Use of language:

- Identify
 - Meaning of the word
 - What it suggests about
- Demonstrate understanding of the word/phrase in context
- Not about providing the dictionary definition but how the word is being used in the context → contextual meaning

Interpretation:

- Interpret the figurative expression → ideas are not explicitly stated
- Need to interpret using the context

Inference:

- Need to make an inference based on the information provided in the text

AQ

Elements of AQ: PAESC (point, application, elaboration, substantiation, cohesion) + insight and balance

P: select a relevant point (paraphrase or with key words)

- condition/context/comparison that the point significant
- judgement about the importance/the impact of the point

A: assert applicability

- condition/context/comparison that set the limits for the applicability
- judgement about limits of applicability and whether it is positive or negative

E: explain using characteristics of Singapore/Singaporeans

- condition/context/contrast/comparison that moderated/exacerbates the impacts/implication
- judgement about Singaporeans reaction/response as a result of the characteristics

S: provide evidence for applicability/explanation

- Evidence that supports/illustrates: applicability and explanation(s) of condition/context/contrast/comparison
- provide evidence to support your judgement

Rule of 3: to prove something is prevalent, need 3 example to show how prevalent it is

Vocab: SGeans would embrace, exploit, subscribe to, utilise, aware, engaged in, employed

For dual passages:

- Must evaluate both passages → must reference both for double passage (e.g "Both writers have merit in their point of view"
- Can reconcile both views → integrate both views

Double passage AQ:

intro

[T] what are the 2 passages about? can combine and write no need individually. Point out they have different/opposing views → not reasonable to agree to both to the same degree in the context of SG

[I] What is the focus of Author 1? What is the focus of Author 2?

[P] What would SGeans think of their position?

BP1

How are Author 1 and Author 2's points similar?

[P] What do Author 1 & Author 2 assert about the topic

[A] What would SGeans think about the point they raise?

[E] Why? Relate this to the specific characteristic(s) and context of SG --> must always connect to point

[S] What evi do you have to justify your position and explanation of SGeans' views

BP 2

How are Author 1 and Author 2's points different?

- Rule of 3: prevalent → need 3 example to show how prevalent it is
- Vocab: Singaporeans would embrace, exploit, subscribe to, utilise, aware, engaged in, employed

Paper 1

Essay qn types:

To what extent:

- Assumes the validity of the assertion
- Explain why the assertion may be valid, balance by explaining → limitations which undermines the validity of (i.e. problems) + limits beyond which the assertion can no longer apply
- limits ≠ exceptions

Absolute question:

- 'Always', 'Only', etc or an assertion that is presented as if it is a fact, i.e. a sweeping statement
- Explain the merit of assumption in the assertion, balance → refute the absoluteness of the assertion
- Not always have the word 'always' in the qn (e.g sporting events ARE a waste of resources)

Evaluation of the effectiveness

- 'Superficial', 'enough' → what is enough? when there's a behavioural change that is sustained.
- Establish the criteria(yardstick) for effectiveness
- Evaluate the degree/extent to which the criteria have been met
- Example of criteria: awareness, changes/action taken, sustainability of the changes, impact on the resolution of the problems (highest effectiveness of strategy is alleviation of problems)
- There are NO solutions in GP
- Do not give lists of measures for evaluation, give measures in the respective discipline

comparative qns (A vs B; A not B; Problems >/< Benefit)

- Explicit comparison of A versus B in terms of a criterion, e.g. SIT → scale, impact, time → significance of events, short term vs long term
- Reducing/ minimising problems - possible solution(s) to problems (hence can be solved in the long term/ SIT), benefits - SIT

'Key' qn

- The most important factor/criteria, necessary
- Must find like with like, compare on the same basis
- Time comparative(past vs present)
- Focus on the changes(what are the new/evolving situations that impact), factors that support continued relevance/importance/etc, what makes it more or less acceptable/continue to be acceptable/unacceptable
- Absolute (always, no place, everyone, etc.)
 - Sweeping statements
 - Merits
 - Refutation of absolute
- Extent (to what extent / how far)
 - Assertion that is general true
 - Merit
 - Limits / Limitations
- Evaluation (effectiveness / possible / solution)
 - Establish criteria for assessment
 - Limits / Limitations

As much as possible, avoid doing comparison qns

Recommended go with the majority view which is already assumed in the question

Key concepts

- Today
 - VUCA → volatile, uncertain, complexity, ambiguity (don't need to use all the characteristics, but need to know them all)
 - Industrialised
 - Globalised
 - Interconnected
 - Interdependent
 - Competing
 - Demographics
 - LGBT-QIA2S+ is an acronym for Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender, Queer and/or Questioning, Intersex, Asexual, Two-Spirit, and the countless affirmative ways in which people choose to self-identify
 - Young/ old/ 'different' people
- Justifiable
 - Right
 - Correct
 - Acceptable
 - Appropriate
 - Desirable
 - Good
 - Beneficial
 - Advantageous
 - Obligation
 - Duty
 - Responsibility
 - Expectation
 - Justice
 - Fairness
 - Equality
 - Equity

Structural Approach

SPECO

ICSNW

Situation

Examples

Paragraph Elements

- Point
- Explanation

- Substantiation
- Cohesion